

Data Feeds & API Resources for a Multi-Asset Trading & Investing Platform

Research dossier: market data, alternative data, sentiment, IPO calendars, insider/institutional tracking, and execution APIs to evaluate for a "one-stop-shop" build

Prepared for: platform development / discovery phase

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Scope: equities, FX, commodities, crypto, options, alt-data, sentiment, macro

Note: this is a research reference, not investment, legal, or compliance advice. Pricing and free-tier limits shift often — re-check each vendor's current pricing page before committing.

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1. Core Market Data APIs

Real-time and historical price data — the foundation layer every other feed sits on top of. "Debento" is Databento — confirmed below.

Platform	What it gives you	Best for	Access / Pricing Signal
Databento databento.com	Institutional-grade real-time & historical tick data direct from 60+ exchange colocation feeds (equities, futures, options, FX). Full order book (MBO/MBP), OHLCV, corporate actions. Raw binary + HTTP API.	Serious quant/algo infrastructure where data provenance and latency actually matter	\$125 free credit; usage-based metering or flat-rate plans, no license markup
Twelve Data twelvedata.com	Stocks, forex, crypto, ETFs, indices across 70+ exchanges; 100+ server-side technical indicators	Broad global coverage in one API without piecing together multiple vendors	Free tier ~800 requests/day (most generous of the "big five"); paid tiers scale from there
Polygon.io polygon.io	Real-time & historical US equities, options, forex, crypto; WebSocket streaming; tick-level history	Production trading apps needing real US market-data infrastructure (this is what Robinhood is built on)	Free tier: 5 calls/min, US stocks only; paid from ~\$29-79+/mo
Financial Modeling Prep (FMP) financialmodelingprep.com	Deep fundamentals: SEC EDGAR-sourced financial statements, ratios, DCF models, earnings call transcripts, 30+ years of history	Fundamental analysis / stock-screening logic ("what shares should I buy")	Free tier 250 req/day; paid plans from ~\$19-29/mo
Alpha Vantage alphavantage.co	Stocks, FX, crypto + 50+ built-in technical indicators (RSI, MACD, etc.)	Prototyping, academic/hobbyist projects, indicator-heavy strategies	Free tier is the most restrictive of the majors; paid from \$49.99/mo
Finnhub finnhub.io	Real-time WebSocket trades (15-min delay on free tier), global fundamentals, economic data, and alt-data extras (congressional trades, ESG scores) bundled in	Fast prototyping — most generous free WebSocket access of any major provider	Free tier: 60 calls/min
EOD Historical Data (EODHD) eodhd.com	150,000+ tickers across 70+ global exchanges, fundamentals, forex, commodities (FRED-sourced), options	International/non-US exchange coverage that US-centric providers skip	Budget-friendly tiered pricing, strong for backtesting pipelines
Intrinio intrinio.com	Rich fundamentals and analytics layer, strong historical depth, less real-time emphasis	Analytics-heavy research tools rather than live trading	Custom/tiered pricing
Tiingo tiingo.com	End-of-day prices, fundamentals, integrated news feed	Economical backtesting data source	Low-cost tiers
Xignite xignite.com	Enterprise-grade reference data, identifiers, and specialty feeds (also powers Nasdaq.com's IPO calendar behind the scenes)	Compliance-grade reference data / identifier mapping	Custom/enterprise pricing

Retire from your shortlist: IEX Cloud is permanently shut down (retired 31 August 2024 by IEX Group). It still appears in a lot of "best API" blog posts and comparison articles because those pages haven't been updated — don't build against it.

2. Broker / Execution APIs

Data tells you what to buy; these are the rails that actually place the order once your platform decides. Worth mapping early even though this is a later build phase.

PLATFORM	WHAT IT GIVES YOU	BEST FOR	NOTES
Alpaca alpaca.markets	Commission-free, API-first broker for stocks, options, crypto; paper-trading sandbox; WebSocket order/position events; also a "Broker API" to white-label trading inside your own app	Developer-led products, algo trading, embedding brokerage directly into your platform	Self-clearing broker-dealer; strong SDK support (Python, others)
Interactive Brokers (IBKR) API interactivebrokers.com	The most comprehensive multi-asset execution API in the industry — equities, options, futures, FX, bonds across ~150 markets/33 countries	Non-US investors, multi-asset strategies, institutional-grade infrastructure	Steeper integration curve than Alpaca (TWS API / FIX / ib_insync wrapper commonly used)
OANDA API developer.oanda.com	Streaming FX/CFD price feeds paired with REST endpoints for orders, positions, and transaction history	FX-focused execution pipelines specifically	Clean REST + streaming design, good audit trail for reconciliation
Tradier tradier.com	Cloud-based brokerage API, equities and options focus	US-focused developer apps, quick onboarding	Simpler surface than IBKR if you don't need global multi-asset execution

3. IPO Data & Calendars

"What IPOs are coming up" — from the earliest S-1 filing signal through pricing and post-IPO performance tracking.

Platform	What it gives you	Best for	Access / Pricing Signal
Renaissance Capital IPO Center renaissancecapital.com	The industry-standard IPO calendar, pricing history, sector analysis, lockup expirations, and a Renaissance IPO Index	The single best "IPO desk" reference for a retail-scale platform	IPO Pro \$119/mo (\$1,187/yr); IPO Intelligence (institutional) \$39,300/yr; IPO data also available via API on request
Nasdaq IPO Calendar nasdaq.com/market-activity/ipos	Free, EDGAR-sourced expected IPO dates, priced deals, and performance	A free baseline feed while you evaluate paid options	Free on the website; the underlying data also flows through Nasdaq Data Link
Xignite IPO Calendar API xignite.com	Programmatic IPO calendar and performance data feed	Enterprise integrations wanting a clean IPO-specific endpoint	Custom pricing
FMP / Finnhub IPO endpoints	Both bundle a basic IPO calendar endpoint into their broader market-data plans	Cheapest route if you're already paying for one of these for price data	Included in existing subscription tiers
SEC Edgar S-1 / F-1 filings (via Full-Text Search or sec-api.io)	The earliest possible IPO signal — registration statements filed before a company even reaches a public calendar	Getting ahead of calendar aggregators rather than relying on their downstream repackaging	Free at source (see Section 4); sec-api.io wraps it faster/structured

4. Congressional, Insider & Institutional Data

"What are other people buying" — congress members, corporate insiders, and hedge funds/institutions. Quiver Quant is the platform you already found; here's how it compares to its closest peers.

Platform	What it gives you	Best for	Access / Pricing Signal
Quiver Quantitative quiverquant.com / api.quiverquant.com	Congressional stock trades, Form 4 insider transactions, government contracts, corporate lobbying, r/WallStreetBets mentions, dark-pool short volume, 13F changes, Google Trends, patents, app-store ratings — the broadest single alt-data bundle for retail-accessible pricing	The best breadth-for-cost starting point for "what is everyone else buying"	Premium \$25/mo (\$300/yr); official Python wrapper (quiverquant package) available
Unusual Whales unusualwhales.com	Options flow, dark pool prints, congressional trades, insider Form 4s, 13F/13D/13G institutional filings, short interest & borrow fees, technical screening — all through one documented REST API + an MCP server	Combining "smart money" tracking with real-time options/dark-pool signals in one feed	Subscription-based; full OpenAPI spec published
WhaleWisdom whalewisdom.com	The deepest 13F institutional-holdings analysis available: fund-level portfolio history, quarter-over-quarter position changes, WhaleScore conviction ranking, sector heat maps	Serious hedge-fund/13F research (with the caveat that 13F data is always 45-90 days stale)	Free tier + premium alerts/filtering tiers
Fintel fintel.io	13F institutional ownership + short interest/borrow fee + insider transactions + options flow + analyst ratings + a proprietary short-squeeze score, all in one dashboard	A single "institutional signals" dashboard rather than stitching several tools together	Free + paid tiers
Capitol Trades capitoltrades.com	Free congressional-trading tracker — good as a cross-check against Quiver's parsed data	Free sanity-checking, not a primary feed	Free (web UI; no official public API)
OpenInsider openinsider.com	Free, no-frills Form 4 insider buying/selling screener	Lightweight insider-trading cross-reference	Free
SEC EDGAR (direct) sec.gov/edgar	The ultimate source of truth behind every tool above: Submissions API (all filings per company), XBRL Company Facts API (structured financial data), Full-Text Search API (18M+ filings since 1993/2001, indexed within ~60 seconds of publication)	Building your own parsing layer instead of paying a reseller markup — more engineering work, zero data cost	Free, no API key required for the core public endpoints

5. Options Flow, Short Interest & Dark Pool Data

Time-sensitive institutional positioning signals — these move much faster than 13F filings.

Platform	What it gives you	Best for
Unusual Whales	Real-time options sweeps/blocks, dark-pool prints with NBBO context, short interest, shares available to short, borrow fee rates	The current leading retail-accessible options-flow + dark-pool API
Fintel	Advanced short interest and borrow-fee data, proprietary Short Squeeze Score	Squeeze-candidate screening layered on top of institutional data you're already pulling
Ortex	Dedicated short-interest and securities-lending data specialist	A second, independent short-interest source to cross-validate Fintel/Unusual Whales
CBOE / OCC official data	Exchange-native options data direct from source	Production-grade options chains alongside Databento/Polygon's options datasets, if you outgrow the retail-tier tools

6. Social & Retail Sentiment Data

Crowd psychology as a contrarian and momentum signal — pairs well with the "smart money" data in Section 4 as its retail-side counterweight.

Platform	What it gives you	Best for
Stocktwits API stocktwits.com	The largest trader-specific social network (6M+ members): message streams, daily bullish/bearish sentiment index, trending-symbol leaderboard	The single best "retail chatter" source, purpose-built for trading (vs. general social media)
ApeWisdom	Free API for Reddit ticker-mention rankings across r/wallstreetbets, r/stocks, r/investing	Free WSB-style sentiment without building your own Reddit scraper
LunarCrush lunarcrush.com	Social sentiment, Galaxy Score, and AltRank across 4,000+ cryptocurrencies and 2,000+ stocks, aggregating X, Reddit, YouTube, and TikTok	Crypto-specific social sentiment (its original and strongest use case)
Google Trends (pytrends)	Free search-volume proxy for retail attention; academic research shows spikes precede price moves by 1–3 days	A free, easy early-attention signal to layer on top of everything else

7. News & Regulatory Filings

PLATFORM	WHAT IT GIVES YOU	BEST FOR
Benzinga News / SEC Filings API benzinga.com/apis	Real-time market news feed plus a direct EDGAR-integrated filings search with custom alerts	A premium, trading-desk-grade news feed if budget allows
SEC EDGAR Full-Text Search sec.gov/edgar/search	Official, free search across all filings since 2001, indexed within ~60 seconds of publication	Zero-cost filings monitoring — build your own alerting on top of it
sec-api.io	Commercial wrapper around EDGAR: 18M+ filings since 1993, faster indexing (as low as 300ms), XBRL parsing, real-time filing stream, PDF/Word/Excel conversion	Skipping the engineering work of parsing raw EDGAR yourself
Marketaux / NewsAPI / Finnhub News / Polygon News	General-purpose financial news APIs, several with built-in sentiment scoring	Cheaper alternatives to Benzinga if you don't need trading-desk-grade speed

8. Macroeconomic Data

Rates, inflation, and growth data — the context layer that explains why everything else is moving.

PLATFORM	WHAT IT GIVES YOU	BEST FOR	ACCESS / PRICING SIGNAL
FRED (Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis) fred.stlouisfed.org	800,000+ economic time series: GDP, CPI, unemployment, Fed funds rate, Treasury yields, money supply	The standard, free base layer for all US macro data — most commodity/macro resellers repackage this exact source	Free, official REST API, effectively unlimited for reasonable use
Trading Economics tradingeconomics.com	196 countries, indicators + forecasts + an economic calendar of scheduled releases	Global (non-US) macro coverage and forward-looking forecasts FRED doesn't provide	Standard plan ~\$199/mo, capped at 500 requests/month; Economic Calendar API is Enterprise-only/custom pricing
EIA (US Energy Information Administration) eia.gov	Official weekly energy/commodity spot prices — the primary source most commodity APIs (including EODHD's) repackage	Cutting out the reseller markup on energy commodity data specifically	Free, official API

9. Commodities-Specific Feeds

PLATFORM	WHAT IT GIVES YOU	BEST FOR
Databento Futures	Direct venue feeds from CME, NYMEX, CBOT, ICE, EEX for energy, agriculture, and metals futures	Institutional-grade commodity futures data with real order-book depth
EODHD Commodities API	23 commodity series sourced from FRED/EIA, daily/weekly/monthly intervals going back decades	A budget-friendly commodities layer to pair with an equities/FX subscription you already have
Twelve Data Commodities	Precious/industrial metals, energy, and agricultural prices bundled into the same plan as its equities/FX data	One-subscription simplicity if Twelve Data is already your core feed
CommodityPriceAPI / API Ninjas / FinanceFlowAPI	Small, cheap commodity-only feeds (from ~\$5-20/mo) covering gold, oil, ags, livestock	MVP/prototype stage before you need Databento-level futures depth

10. Crypto Market Data & On-Chain Analytics

Platform	What it gives you	Best for	Access / Pricing Signal
CoinGecko API coingecko.com/en/api	18,000+ coins, 1,500+ exchanges, plus on-chain DEX data (39M+ tokens across 250+ chains via GeckoTerminal)	The best overall balance of coverage, latency, and cost for most builds	Free demo tier; commercial plans from ~\$35/mo
CoinMarketCap API coinmarketcap.com/api	2.4M+ tokens, 790+ exchanges — the most recognized brand in the space	General-purpose market data if brand recognition/legacy integration matters	Hobbyist plan from ~\$35/mo
CoinDesk (formerly CryptoCompare/CCData)	Nanosecond-timestamped tick data, Level-2 order book snapshots, AMM swap tracking across 7,000+ assets/300+ exchanges	Quant/institutional-grade crypto data needs	Contact sales for pricing
Glassnode glassnode.com	800+ entity-adjusted on-chain metrics across 23 categories (addresses, miners, derivatives, DeFi, mempool) covering 1,700+ assets, delivered via REST, Snowflake, or an Excel add-in	Real on-chain intelligence, not just price — the standard for serious crypto research	Contact sales; Enterprise/custom pricing

11. Multi-Asset Trading Apps — Context, Not Data Sources

Liquid.trade (app.liquid.trade) is a leveraged perpetuals trading app — not a data feed provider. It lets users go long/short (up to ~200x on some markets) across crypto, US/international stocks, commodities, FX, and even pre-IPO private-company names (SpaceX, OpenAI, Anthropic) through synthetic perpetual contracts, all from one non-custodial interface with no KYC. It raised an \$18M Series Seed round in April 2026 (co-led by Neo and Left Lane Capital), on top of a \$7.6M seed round six months earlier, and reports \$3B+ in trading volume across ~40,000 users since its August 2025 launch.

It's genuinely useful to study for *product design*

12. Unified Aggregator / Gateway APIs

A newer category worth knowing about: single-API layers that normalize several of the sources above behind one schema and one key. Worth evaluating once you know which underlying sources you actually want — they save integration time but add a dependency layer between you and the raw data.

- **QVeris** — unified gateway across 15+ categories/10,000+ capabilities spanning many of the providers listed in Section 1.
- **FinancialData.net** — positions itself as a more "product-friendly" single API vs. piecing together Alpha Vantage/Finnhub/Polygon separately.
- **StockAPIS / Anysite** — normalize sources like FRED, Stocktwits, Finviz, and Reddit into one consistent schema, useful specifically for the alt-data/sentiment layer.

13. Suggested Starter Stack & Architecture Notes

A reasonable v1 combination to prototype against before committing to enterprise contracts:

- **Prices (equities/FX/crypto):** Twelve Data or Finnhub for breadth while prototyping; graduate to Databento or Polygon.io once latency/depth matters.
- **Fundamentals:** Financial Modeling Prep.
- **Smart money / alt-data:** Quiver Quantitative as the broad starting bundle; add Unusual Whales once you want real-time options/dark-pool flow layered in.
- **IPOs:** Nasdaq's free calendar to start, Renaissance Capital IPO Pro once you want deeper analysis; SEC EDGAR S-1 monitoring for the earliest signal.
- **Sentiment:** Stocktwits + ApeWisdom (free) to start; LunarCrush if crypto is a major focus.
- **Macro:** FRED (free) as the backbone; Trading Economics if you need non-US coverage and forecasts.
- **Commodities:** EODHD's Commodities API to start; Databento Futures if you build out serious futures-trading logic.
- **Crypto + on-chain:** CoinGecko for market data; Glassnode once on-chain analytics become a real feature, not a nice-to-have.
- **Execution:** Alpaca to start (fastest to integrate, good sandbox); Interactive Brokers when you need real multi-asset, multi-market execution; OANDA if FX execution is a dedicated module.

Architecturally, this points toward an internal **data normalization layer**: one ingestion service per category above, each writing into a common internal schema (ticker, timestamp, source, value type), so your "master platform" logic (screening, alerts, signals) never has to know which vendor a given data point came from. This is also what lets you swap a vendor later without rewriting the platform.

14. Things to Watch Before You Build

- **Redistribution rights are the real gatekeeper.** Almost every exchange-sourced feed (equities/options tick data especially) restricts *redistribution* separately from *use* — i.e., what you're allowed to display to your own end users can require a different (often costlier) license than what you pay to use the data internally. This is the single biggest legal/cost trap in building a "platform" on top of resold market data — confirm redistribution terms directly with each vendor (Databento, Polygon, and exchange-direct feeds are explicit about this; verify before assuming a developer-tier plan covers a public-facing product).
- **13F and congressional data is inherently delayed** (45–90 days for 13F, up to 45 days for congressional disclosures under the STOCK Act) — treat it as a research/context input, never a real-time signal.
- **Free tiers change without notice** — IEX Cloud's shutdown in 2024 is the cautionary tale here; don't build a single point of failure on any one free API, especially for anything customer-facing.
- **Cross-reference alternative-data sources** (e.g., Quiver vs. Capitol Trades for congressional trades, Fintel vs. Ortex for short interest) rather than trusting one parser of public disclosures — scraping/parsing errors do happen.
- This document is a research aid, not legal or financial advice — before signing any commercial data license, especially ones you intend to redistribute through your own platform, it's worth having actual contract terms reviewed.

Compiled from live web research, 29 July 2026. Pricing, free-tier limits, and product availability change frequently — reconfirm current terms directly with each vendor before committing engineering time or budget.